

Sex. Violence. Racy Rap.

The iPod, PSP and facebook generation is growing up in a virtual world where video games encourage them to rape and beat up women, social networking sites limit their world view and where TV shows them an array of adults behaving badly, from WWE champs clad in underwear to reality stars without it



Video Games

Each game comes with its own tasks. In Driver 76, a mafia don assigns tasks such as stealing a car and frequently uses words like f*** and ass. In the even more controversial Grand Theft Auto (GTA) series, players can become criminals in a big city and in GTA III and GTA IV, can even have sex with prostitutes and then take their money back.



By Rohit Parihar and Kaveree Bamzai

You see them in your homes, fingers on buttons, heads bowed in deep benediction to a flickering screen, wires protruding from their ears connected to racy rap speaking the language of the street. Call them an army in search of salvation, a mind-bending mix of visual stimulation and aural excitement. Parents, instead of being grateful for the array of digital babysitters, please pay a little attention to them. The lyrics booming in their heads are probably urging them to "look at her dancing/just take it off" like the Black Eyed Peas. The virtual Grand Theft Auto video game is perhaps guiding them to have sex with a prostitute in a car and then beat her up to take their money back. The laptops open on their desks are possibly beaming their latest status update to everyone: life sucks. Or f*** off, world. Ah yes, and the night is not yet over. At 10 p.m., they have a date with WWE where they will watch grown men in their underwear challenging each other to blood feuds, with the prize being anything from a shiny trashy belt to a beautiful woman.

It's a world where parents have voluntarily abdicated their responsibility, absenting themselves physically and emotionally, allowing all manner of strangers to raise their children. And no, we are not talking Kantabai that the Genesis Global School is so worried is becoming your child's guru. The Beautiful People on TNA can wag their mini-skirted butts in the air as they enter the ring, urging the camera to zoom in and Akon can tell them that the "sexy chick" he is referring to is better than the neighbourhood "hoe". Yes, they're

Social Networking Sites

Social networking sites where children even less than 13 have accounts, allow them to chat with friends, take quizzes on whom they would like to date, or who they have a crush on. They are often sources of spam mails which enable them to access porn sites. They are also a stamping ground for paedophiles as in Johnson County, USA, recently where an ex-coach posed as a 19-year-old girl to get nude pictures of 13-year-old boys.